

British Council. Students from six universities in the State are being given training at the University of East London and the University of Dundee under the Scholarships for Outstanding Talent (SCOUT).

CHEVENING SCHOLARSHIP

The Chevening Karnataka Post-graduate Scholarship has been established in partnership with the Department of Higher Education and the United Kingdom's (UK) Commonwealth and Development Office for the year 2025-26.

Under this scholarship, the Chevening Secretariat of the UK and the Government of Karnataka will bear the entire cost of one year of postgraduate study in any discipline of their choice in the UK for the next three years.

MOUS WITH FOREIGN UNIVERSITIES

With an aim to provide quality education, an academic, subject-based agreements entered into by the Department of Higher Education with various foreign universities.

The Karnataka State Higher Education Council (KSHEC) signed MoU with the University of Salford, UK. In order to promote cooperation between the parties, both institutions will encourage direct contact and cooperation between their faculty and administration, joint research collaborations, entrepreneur and entrepreneurial activities, staff exchange programmes and opportunities, student and faculty development, promotion of the Salford Study Abroad Programme, Joint curricula development.

MoU between British Council and KSHEC - To strength educational and cultural cooperation to support the knowledge ambitions and economic growth of Karnataka State by creating opportunities for young people to improve access to high quality and internationally benchmarked educational qualifications, exchange of culture, creativity and ideas.

MoU between University of Wolverhampton and KSHEC - to improve access to quality education, skill development. infrastructure development, research opportunities and internationally benchmarked assessments, professional growth of educators and students, and foster the exchange of research. creativity and ideas.

MoU between Government of Karnataka and University of Liverpool, UK., for Research and innovation activities, Education cooperation, Joint research ventures.

Also, many public universities and private universities and autonomous institutions in the State have entered into MoU with many foreign universities.

DEPARTMENT OF COLLEGIATE EDUCATION

Recognising the need for AI in higher education, the department of Collegiate Education is organising capacity building programmes on AI for students and teachers at various levels and education levels.

Among these, AI training for 1,350 female students and one-day workshops for about 300 computer science teachers in partnership with Learning Link Foundation are noteworthy. AI lessons have already been included in the computer science curriculum. BCA courses that create jobs have been started in government degree colleges.

Establishment of centers of excellence, incubation and innovation centres, competitive research grants and establishment of government chairs in institutions of national importance, and development of intellectual property have also been emphasised.

DEPARTMENT OF TECHNICAL EDUCATION

The department has taken steps to develop competitive and job-oriented skills for higher education students of the State.

In 2025-26, skill-based curricula have been implemented in the Polytechnic Diploma and engineering courses in collaboration with experienced industry leaders. The said curricula have been implemented with practically oriented subjects that are in line with the latest innovations, technological changes and industrial requirements in the technical fields. Greater priority has been given to practical based training, industrial visits, mini projectors and industrial problem-based learning methods.

To achieve over all development of government higher educational institutions through skill training, English language proficiency, online courses, these training programmes, which are being implemented through Corporate Social Responsibility (CSR) funds, have been signed MoU with organisations like Vadhyani Foundation, Unnati Foundation, Infosys String Board.

Reserve Bank Innovation Hub (RBIH):

The Department of Collegiate Education has signed MoU with RBIH to implement RBIH Fintech with the aim of promoting Fintech entrepreneurship, especially in Tier-2 and Tier-3 cities. In the first phase, the RBIH Fintech programme is being implemented in 10 selected government first-grade colleges across the state.

AEDP PROGRAMMES

To provide job opportunities to students, the Higher Education Department had launched four new AEDPs in 45 government first grade colleges in 21 districts in the 2024-25 academic year.

The four new degree programmes are B.Com in retail, B.Com in logistics, B.Com in e-commerce and B.Com in banking, finance, service, and insurance.

In response to increased demand from students, it has extended the AEDP in B.Com courses to 85 government first-grade colleges across the State for the 2025-26 academic year.

Under this programme, students will pursue a regular college education in the first and second year and undergo apprenticeship training with companies in their final year. The students will get a stipend from ₹8,000 to ₹18,000 depending upon capability.

FOREIGN UNIVERSITIES

The Karnataka Government has given permission to foreign universities to establish their campuses in the State. Three foreign universities have already received permission from the University Grant Commission (UGC) and State Government to set-up their campuses.

University of Liverpool (UK) is setting up its first India campus in Whitefield of Bengaluru, focused on technology and management, with plans to operate soon.

Lancaster University (UK) is planning to establish its campus in Electronic City of Bengaluru in the academic year of 2026-27, targeting to offer accredited degrees in business and cyber security. Imperial College London (UK) will establish a research wing in collaboration with local institutions. And, University of Wolverhampton (UK) has already set up a research centre at Dr.Manmohan Bengaluru City University